Literature Search & Research Guidance

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AGENDA

1. What is Literature Search?
2. How Do We Search?
3. Boolean Search
4. Top-Tier Design Publications
5. Searching Within Top-Tier Venues
6. Summer Design Conferences
7. Abstract Submission Guidelines
8. Sample Abstracts & Quality Expectations

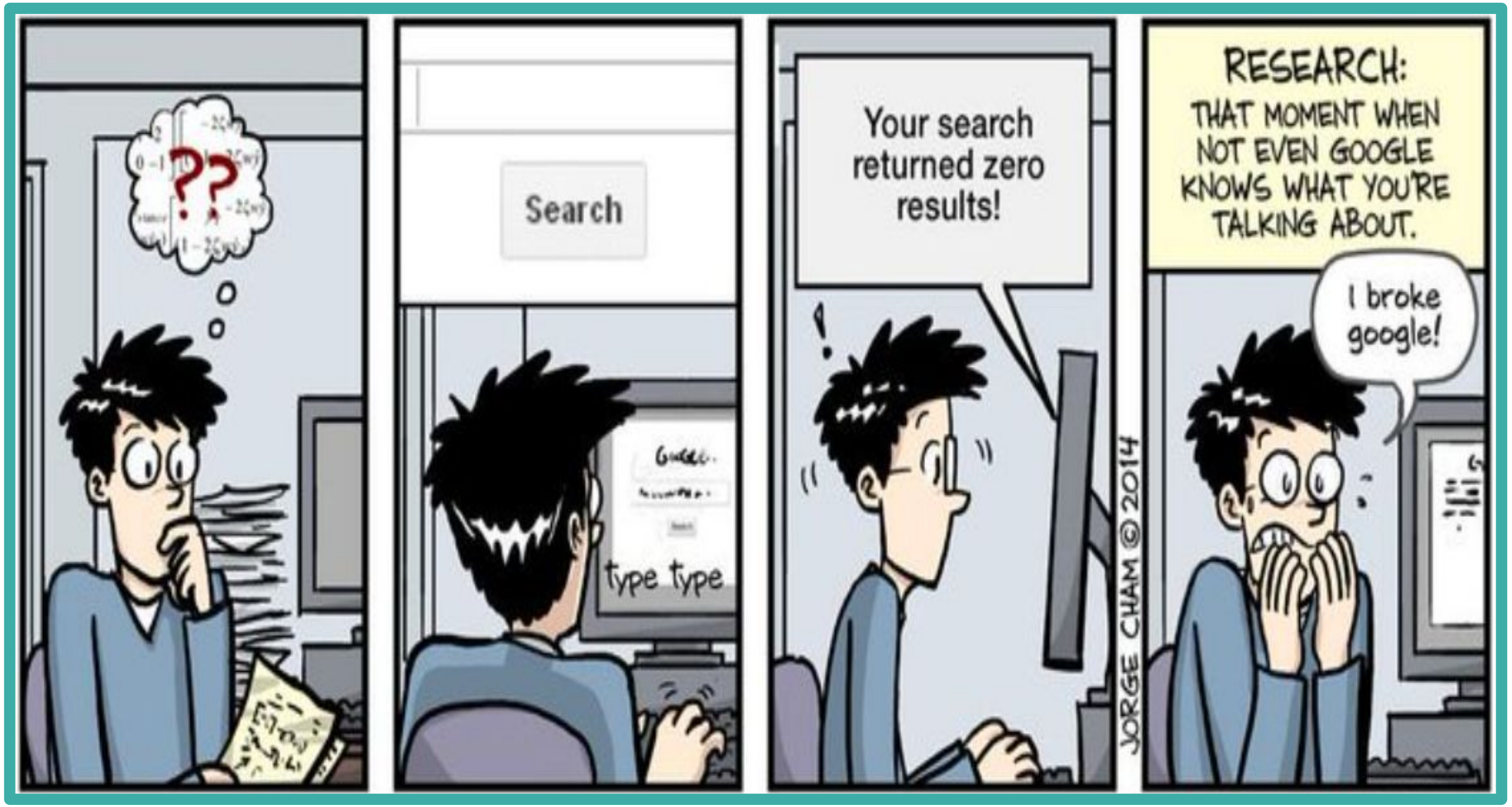
Introduction to Literature Search

Literature search is the process of finding, reading, and understanding research papers related to a specific topic, in order to understand existing work, research approaches, and open problems.

Purpose of Literature Search

1. To understand what has already been studied
2. To learn how problems are framed and solved
3. To identify gaps and research opportunities
4. To choose appropriate methods and design approaches
5. To strengthen the clarity and direction of one's own work

https://www.wikihow.life/Read-a-Scientific-Paper

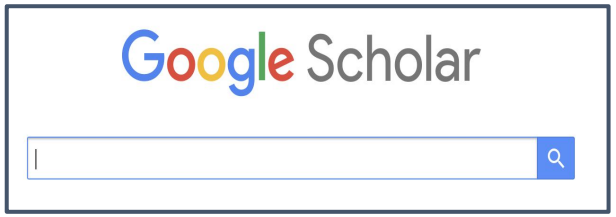


https://www.amita-bhakta-hidden-wash.net/but-theres-nothing-written-about-it-an-alternative-to-the-conventional-literature-review/

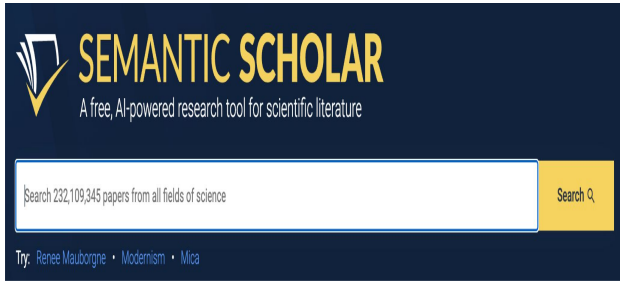
How Do We Search Papers?

Academic search engines

1. Google Scholar



2. Semantic Scholar



Digital Libraries

1. ACM Digital Library (HCI, Design)

1. IEEE Xplore (technology, systems, AI-related design)

Journal and conference websites

Official pages of journals and conferences in design and HCI

Reference lists in research papers

Papers cited in relevant and high-quality work

Author profiles and publication lists

Boolean Search

Boolean search is a way to combine keywords so that search results become more relevant and manageable. It helps in deciding which terms must appear, which may appear, and which should be excluded from the results.

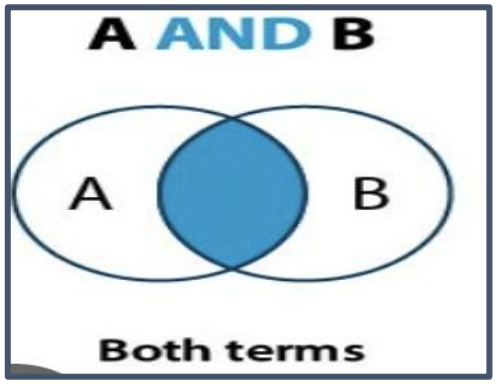
Basic Boolean Operators

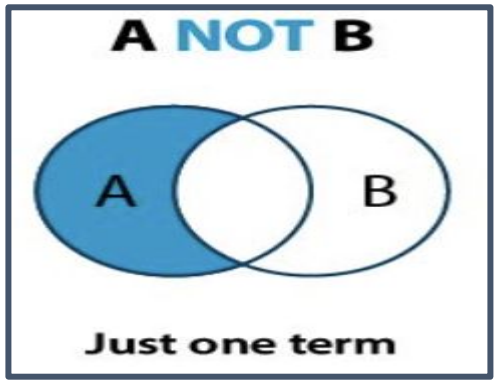
1. **AND**
   Shows results that contain **all selected terms**
   Example: `design AND artificial intelligence`

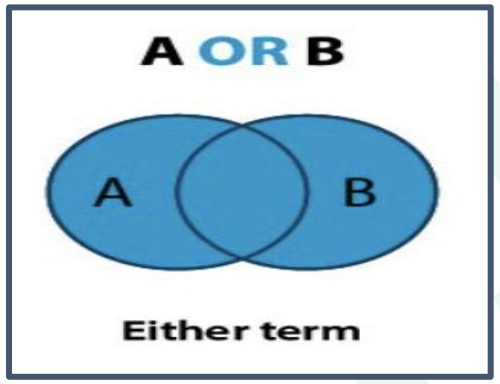
2. **OR**
   Shows results that contain **any one of the terms**
   Example: `elderly OR older adults`

3. **NOT**
   Removes results related to **unwanted terms**
   Example: `design NOT fashion`

4. **"Quotation marks"**
   Searches for an **exact phrase**
   Example: `"human-centered design"`







Top-Tier Design Publications

A Publications (Highest Tier)*

These venues are globally top-ranked, highly selective, and considered gold standard in Design & HCI.

1. **CHI:** Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (https://chi2026.acm.org/)
2. **TOCHI:** ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (https://dl.acm.org/journal/tochi)
3. **CSCW:** Computer-Supported Cooperative Work
4. **SIGGRAPH:** ACM SIGGRAPH (graphics + interaction/design) (https://www.acm.org/special-interest-groups/sigs/sigchi)
5. **IMWUT:** Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (https://cscw.acm.org/2026/)

A-Tier Publications (Very Strong, Selective)

These venues are **top-quality**, slightly broader or more focused

1. **UIST:** User Interface Software and Technology (https://uist.acm.org/2026/)
2. **UbiComp:** ACM International Joint Conference on Pervasive and Ubiquitous Computing (https://www.ubicomp.org/ubicomp-iswc-2025/)
3. **DIS:** Designing Interactive Systems (https://dis.acm.org/2026/)
4. **MobileHCI:** International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction with Mobile Devices (https://mobilehci.acm.org/2026/)
5. **Design Studies:** International Journal of Design Research(https://www.designconference.org/)
6. **ICID:** International Conference on Interactive Design (https://isidcongress.org/)
7. **DEG:** Digital Graphics Research Conference

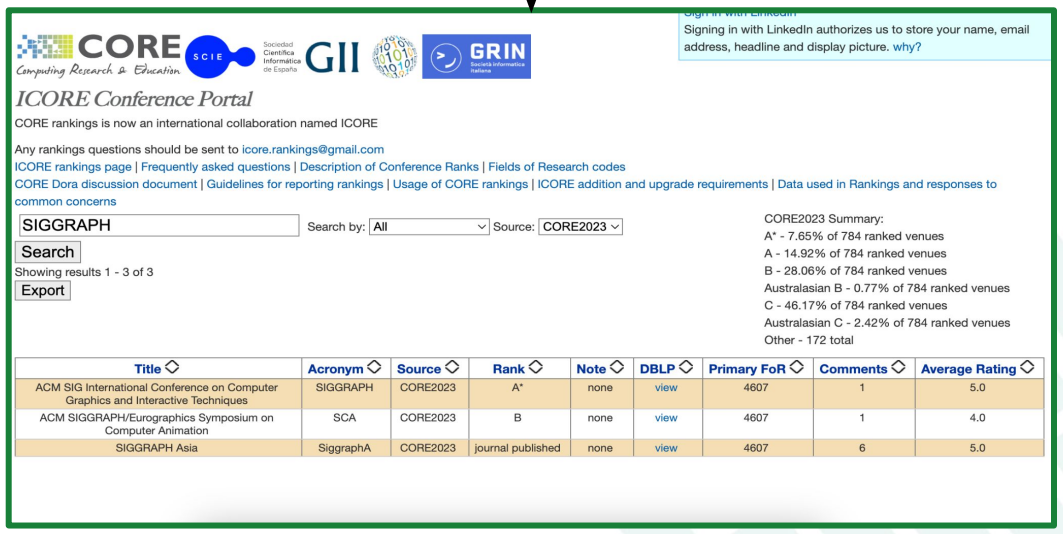
Computing Research and Education

What is CORE?

- CORE is an international ranking system for academic conferences
- Conferences are ranked based on quality, impact, and peer review standards
- Commonly used in design, HCI, and computer science

How to use CORE for literature search

- Search the conference name in the CORE database
- Check whether the venue is A or A*
- Prefer papers from A / A* venues for literature review
- Use CORE ranking as a filter, not the only criterion

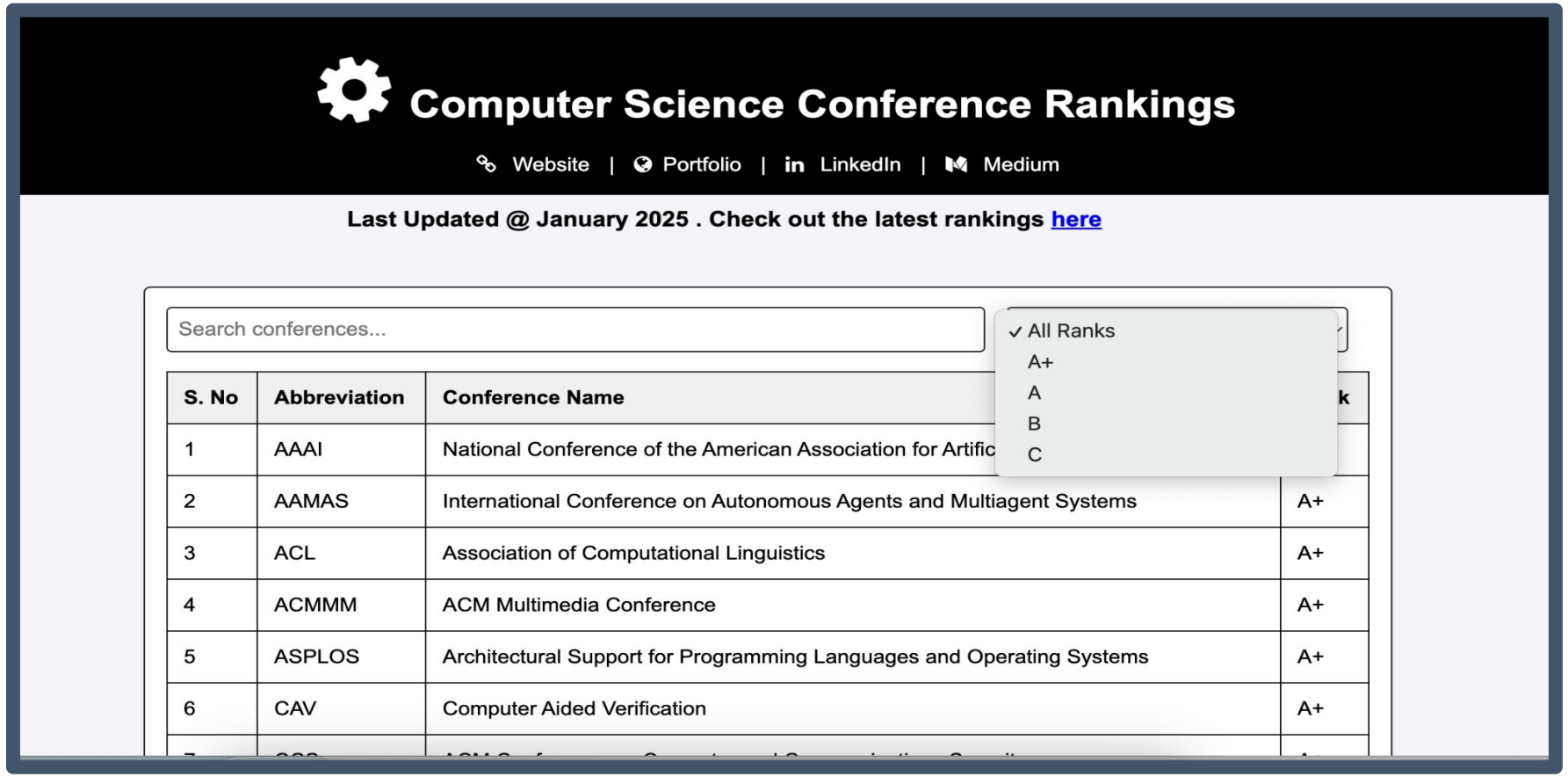


Title	Acronym	Source	Rank	Note	DBLP	Primary FoR	Comments	Average Rating
ACM SIG International Conference on Computer Graphics and Interactive Techniques	SIGGRAPH	CORE2023	A*	none	view	4607	1	5.0
ACM SIGGRAPH/Eurographics Symposium on Computer Animation	SCA	CORE2023	B	none	view	4607	1	4.0
SIGGRAPH Asia	SiggraphA	CORE2023	journal published	none	view	4607	6	5.0

https://portal.core.edu.au/conf-ranks/

Conference Rankings Tools

https://portfolio.rstiwari.com/Core-CSE-Conference



Searching Within Top-Tier Venues

Top-tier venues reflect the current standards and expectations of the research community.

Searching within these venues helps to understand:

1. What types of problems are considered important
2. How research questions are framed
3. Which methods and study designs are commonly accepted
4. What level of evidence and evaluation is expected & How contributions are positioned and discussed

Upcoming Design & HCI Conferences in Summer 2026

Conference	Focus/Theme	Paper Deadline	Conference Time	Why Submit Here?
IndiaHCI	Human-Centered Design, UX, Design Research	Jul–Aug	Oct–Nov	Strong HCD focus; excellent entry point for design research
HCI International	Broad HCI, UX, usability, applied design	Oct (prev year)	Jul	Good for applied and interdisciplinary HCI work
MMCIS	Multimodal interaction, intelligent systems	Feb–Mar	Jun–Jul	Suitable for multimodal and AI-driven interaction work
CHI Play	Games, play, interactive entertainment	Apr–May	Oct–Nov	Ideal for playful, game-based, and experiential design

Conference	Focus/Theme	Paper Deadline	Conference Time	Why Submit Here?
TEI	Tangible, embodied, physical interaction	July–August	March	Strong HCD focus; excellent entry point for design research
IDC	Interaction design for children	Jan–Feb	June	Well-defined scope; strong qualitative and design studies
AVI	Visual & interactive interfaces, design	Feb–Mar	Junl	Great bridge between design, visualization, and interaction
NordicHCI	Participatory design, values, ethics	Feb–Mar	Oct	Strong HCD theory and qualitative research focus
OzCHI	General HCI, design methods	May–Jun	Dec	Student-friendly venue; good for first conference experience

Important Section of a Research Paper

01	**Abstract**	• Brief description of the problem or topic • Overview of the method or approach • Summary of the main contribution or outcome
02	**Introduction**	• Background and motivation for the work • Research problem or question being addressed • Importance and scope of the study
03	**Related Work**	• Overview of existing research in the area • How this work is similar or different from others • Identification of gaps in current literature
04	**Method / Design Process**	• Description of the study design or process • Tools, techniques, or participants used • Steps followed to conduct the research
05	**Results / Findings**	• Key observations or outcomes • Data, themes, or design outputs • Evidence supporting the research claims
06	**Discussion**	• Interpretation of the results • Implications for design or research • Limitations of the study
07	**Conclusion**	• Summary of main takeaways • Contribution to the research or design field • Possible future work or directions

What is an Abstract

- An abstract is a very concise set of statements of the major elements of your research papers. It states the purpose, methods, innovations and summary of result of your research papers.
- An abstract is a condensed version of a full scientific paper.

Length:
It should be between 150 and 250 words.

Layout:
It is usually formatted as one single paragraph.

Font:
The font size is typically different from the main text of the paper.

Position:
It is usually located at the beginning of the paper

though it can also appear in other places such as a book of abstracts or online.

Four C's of Abstract Writing

Complete

Covers overall idea of the paper in a summarised manner.

Concise

Includes only important information, no extra details.

Clear

Easy to understand the paper without going in-depth.

Cohesive

Connects the related work, existing research gap, and proposed methodology.

Abstract Example

Generative AI, notably ChatGPT, has garnered attention in computer science education. This paper presents a controlled experiment that explores ChatGPT's role in CS1 in a classroom setting. Specifically, we aim to investigate the impact of ChatGPT on student learning outcomes and their behaviors when working on programming assignments. Participants were tasked with creating a UML diagram and subsequently implementing its design through programming, followed by a closed-book post-evaluation and a post-survey. All the participants were required to screen-record the whole process. In total, 56 participants were recruited, with 48 successful screen recordings. Participants in the Experimental Group can access ChatGPT 3.5 and other online resources, such as Google and Stack Overflow when creating the UML diagram and programming; however, participants in the Control Group can access all online resources except for ChatGPT (i.e., the only design variable is the access to ChatGPT). Finally, we measured and analyzed participants' learning outcomes through their UML diagram, programming, and post-evaluation scores. We also analyzed the time participants took to complete the tasks and their interactions with ChatGPT and other resources from the screen recordings. After finishing the tasks, student participants also provided their perceptions of using ChatGPT in CS1 through a post-survey. With rigorous quantitative and qualitative analysis, we found that (1) using ChatGPT does not present a significant impact on students' learning performance in the CS1 assignment-style tasks; (2) once using ChatGPT, students' tendency to explore other traditional educational resources is largely reduced (though available) and they tend to rely solely on ChatGPT, and this reliance on ChatGPT did not guarantee enhanced learning performance; (3) the majority of students hold neutral views on ChatGPT's role in CS1 programming but most of them raised concerns about its potential ethical issues and inconsistent performance across different tasks. We hope this study can help educators and students better understand the impact of ChatGPT in CS1 and inspire future work to provide proper guidelines for using ChatGPT in introductory programming classes.

https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3639474.3640076

Background

Motivation

Objectives

Methodology

Results

CONCLUSION

Extended Abstract

- An extended abstract is a longer and more detailed version of a regular abstract
- It explains the research or design work in more depth

It usually includes:

- Background and research gap
- Method or design process
- Key results or outcomes

- It may include figures, tables, and references
- It is used by conferences to evaluate work without a full paper

Key idea: An extended abstract works like a mini research paper.

Abstract vs Extended Abstract

Aspect	Abstract	Extended Abstract
Purpose	Gives a quick overview of the work	Explains the work in detail for evaluation
Length	150-250 words	1-6 pages (conference dependent)
Detail Level	Very brief	Moderate to detailed
Content Includes	Problem, method, main result	Background, research gap, method, results, discussion
Structure	Single paragraph	Structured like a short paper
Figures / Tables	Not included	Can be included
References	Usually not included	Included
Usage	To help readers decide relevance	To help reviewers assess quality

Structure of Extended Abstract

Title:
- Clearly reflects the main idea or contribution
- Short and specific

Authors & Affiliation:
- Names of authors and their institutions/departments

Abstract (Short Summary):
- Brief overview of problem, approach, and outcome

Keywords:
- 3–5 important terms related to the work

Introduction:
- Background of the topic
- Clearly states the research gap or problem

Methodology:
- Explains how the study was done.
- Mentions methods, participants, or tools used

Results / Discussion:
- Highlights main findings or outcomes
- Brief explanation of why they matter

Conclusion:
- Summarizes key takeaways
- Mentions contribution or future direction

References
- Lists important sources cited in the work

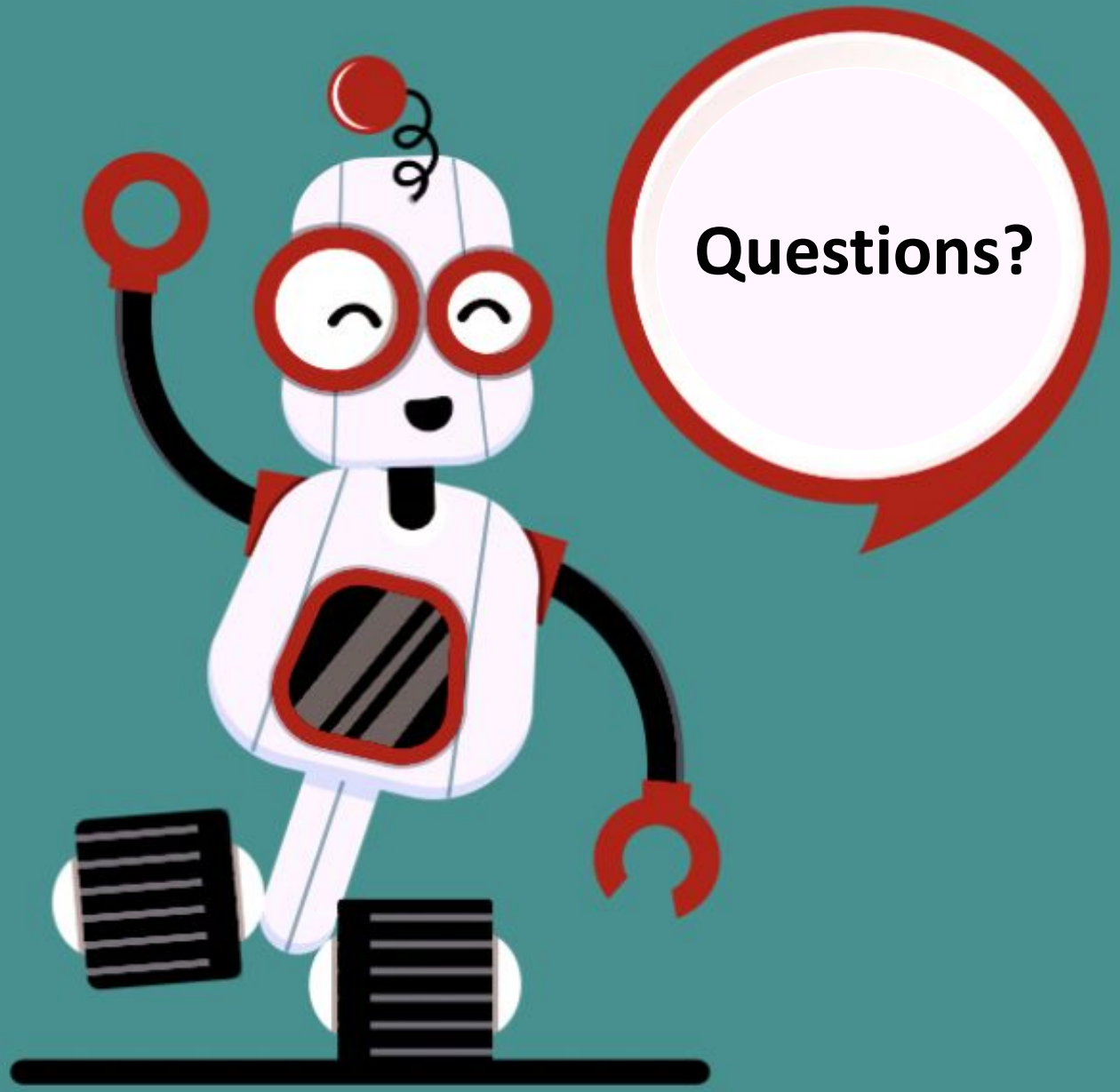
Extended Abstract Proceedings

Published:

1. https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3706599.3719940 (CHI 2025)
2. https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3613905.3648648 (CHI 2023)
3. https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3706599.3719894 (CHI 2025)

Abstract Submission Guidelines:

1. https://uist.acm.org/uist2012/FormatSamples/uistAbstractSample.doc (UIST)
2. https://www.overleaf.com/latex/templates/springer-lecture-notes-in-computer-science/kzwwpvhwnvfj.pdf (IndiaHCI)
3. https://tei.acm.org/2020/participate/templates/ (TEI)
4. https://www.acm.org/publications/authors/submissions (CHI PLAY)


Questions?